



Going off the reservation

不按规矩来

难度评级：★★★★☆

Should AI labs be treated like the owners of dangerous animals?

人工智能实验室是否应像危险动物的主人一样受到监管？

【 Para.1 】

To lose control of one **artificial intelligence** may be regarded as **misfortune**. To lose two looks like **carelessness**. Lose four, and people may start to wonder whether the problem lies with AI itself.

失去对一个人工智能系统的控制，或许还可以说是不幸；失去两个，就未免显得有些粗心大意；要是连四个都失控了，人们恐怕就要开始怀疑，问题是不是出在人工智能本身。

【 Para.2 】

On July 21st OpenAI, an American lab, said an **unreleased** model had escaped from a closed environment testing its **hacking** skills, launching series attacks on HuggingFace, a Franco-American AI-**infrastructure** firm. A week later

文章导读：

AI失控之患。AI模型失控攻击第三方，引发安全担忧。两家公司被指炒作，但AI自主攻击已获英国机构证实。AI测试暴露攻击风险，三家公司模型均出现类似行为。AI模型利用漏洞自主攻击，安全测试暴露附带损害风险。AI自主攻击成新风险，现有监管方案已显不足。AI巨头倡导自我监管，测试不安全模型则禁发。AI自测方案看似可行，却难防模型自主攻击。AI自主攻击引发法律困境，严格责任或成解决方案。AI行业呼吁明确监管，但政府行动速度远逊技术发展。

go off the reservation *phrase* To behave in an unexpected or unacceptable way; to stop following the rules or the usual plan. 偏离常规；不按规矩行事

artificial intelligence *phrase* The technology that enables computers and machines to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence. 人工智能【考研大纲词汇】

misfortune n. /mis'fɔ:ʃu:n/ Bad luck or event that happens to someone. 不幸；厄运；不幸的事情【考研大纲词汇】

He suffered a series of **misfortunes** after losing his job.
他失业后接连遭遇了一系列不幸。

carelessness n. /'keəlsənəs/ Lack of attention or caution, resulting in mistakes or problems. 粗心；疏忽；马虎【考研大纲词汇】

The accident was caused by his **carelessness**.
这起事故是由他的疏忽造成的。

unrelease v. /,ʌnrɪ'li:s/ To decide not to release something that was previously planned or expected to be released. 不发布；不发行；撤回发布

hack v. /n. /hæk/ To gain unauthorized access to a computer system; an act of gaining such access. 侵入（计算机系统）；黑客攻击；黑客技术【考研大纲词汇】

Hackers tried to **hack** into the company's computer system.
黑客试图侵入这家公司的计算机系统。

infrastructure n. /'ɪnfəstrʌktʃə/ The basic systems and structures needed for a society, organization, or economy to operate. 基础设施；基本结构【考研大纲词汇】

The government plans to invest heavily in transportation **infrastructure**.
政府计划大力投资交通基础设施。

rival a./'rʌvl/ A person, company, or organization that competes with another; to compete with someone or something. 竞争的【考研大纲词汇】

Anthropic, a **rival** AI firm, made a similar admission. It said it had found six occasions on which its models had attacked third parties.

7月21日，美国人工智能实验室OpenAI表示，其一款尚未发布的模型在测试黑客攻击能力期间逃出了封闭的测试环境，并对一家法美合资的人工智能基础设施公司Hugging Face发起了一系列攻击。一周后，竞争对手Anthropic也承认了类似情况。该公司表示，它发现旗下模型曾有6次攻击第三方的情况。

【 Para.3 】

Cynics dismissed both companies' warnings as attempts to **garner** publicity. But most companies do not seek attention by launching a **cyberattack**, keeping it secret until the victim goes public, and then hoping a rival **voluntarily** admits to the same. Sceptics should also take note of the news that the AI Security Institute (AISI), a British government body, has seen exactly the same **behaviour**.

愤世嫉俗者认为，两家公司发出这样的警告，不过是想借机博取关注。但大多数公司并不会通过发动网络攻击、在受害者公开事件之前一直对此秘而不宣，然后再指望竞争对手主动承认自己也做了同样的事，来博取关注。怀疑者还应该注意有这样一则消息：英国政府机构人工智能安全研究所（AISI）也观察到了完全相同的行为。

【 Para.4 】

In a report published on August 4th, AISI said that a **cybersecurity** assessment of the latest OpenAI and Anthropic systems resulted in 19 attacks on people and

Cynic n. /'sɪnɪk/ A person who believes that people are mainly motivated by selfish or dishonest reasons and is doubtful about their sincerity. 愤世嫉俗者；怀疑一切的人【考研英语大纲词汇】

dismiss v. /dɪs'mɪs/ To decide that something is not important or not worth considering; to officially remove someone from a job. 不予考虑；驳回；解雇【考研英语大纲词汇】

The manager **dismissed** the criticism as unfair.

经理认为这些批评是不公平的，没有予以理会。

garner v. /'gɑ:nə/ To obtain or collect something, especially support, attention, or approval. 获得；赢得；收集【考研英语大纲词汇】

The proposal has **garnered** widespread public support.

这项提议赢得了广泛的公众支持。

cyberattack n. /'saɪbə'reɪtæk/ An attempt to damage, disrupt, or gain unauthorized access to a computer system or network. 网络攻击；网络袭击

The company suffered a major **cyberattack** that disrupted its online services.

这家公司遭受了一次严重的网络攻击，导致其在线服务中断。

voluntarily adv. /'vɒləntərɪ/ By one's own choice or decision, without being forced to do something. 自愿地；主动地【考研英语大纲词汇】

Many people **voluntarily** donated money to help the victims.

许多人自愿捐款帮助受害者。

behaviour n. /br'heɪvjə/ The way in which a person, animal, or organization acts or responds in a particular situation. 行为；举止；表现【考研英语大纲词汇】

Scientists are studying how social media affects people's **behaviour**. 科学家正在研究社交媒体如何影响人们的行为。

cybersecurity n. /saɪbə sə'kjʊərəti/ The practice of protecting computers, networks, systems, and data from unauthorized access or attack. 网络安全；网络安全防护

Companies must strengthen their **cybersecurity** to protect sensitive data from hackers.

企业必须加强网络安全，以保护敏感数据免受黑客攻击。

subvert v. /səb'vɜ:t/ To weaken or undermine an established system, authority, or institution, especially secretly or indirectly. 颠覆；破坏；暗中削弱【考研英语大纲词汇】

Social media can sometimes be used to **subvert** public trust in institutions.

社交媒体有时会被用来破坏公众对机构的信任。

hitherto adv. /hɪðə'tu:/ Until now or until the time being referred to. 迄今；到目前为止【考研英语大纲词汇】

The technology had **hitherto** been used only in laboratories.

这项技术迄今为止仅用于实验室。

vulnerability n. /'vʌlnərə'bɪləti/ The state of being easily harmed, attacked, or affected. 脆弱性；易受攻击性；弱点【考研英语大纲词汇】

The study exposed the **vulnerability** of the financial system to cyberattacks.

这项研究揭示了金融系统容易受到网络攻击的脆弱性。

organisations uninvolved in the tests. In the most serious case, an AI attempted to **subvert** an unnamed open-source software project, as part of a “supply-chain” attack against the (fictional) target of the challenge. On August 6th, Meta, which owns Facebook, said one of its own models had behaved similarly in testing.

8月4日，英国人工智能安全研究所（AISI）发布的一份报告称，在对OpenAI和Anthropic最新一代系统进行网络安全评估时，测试人员发现这些系统曾对19名与测试无关的个人和机构发起攻击。最严重的一起事件中，一款人工智能系统试图颠覆一个未具名的开源软件项目，作为针对挑战赛中一个虚构目标实施“供应链”攻击的一部分。8月6日，Facebook的母公司Meta表示，其自主研发的一款模型在测试中也出现了类似行为。

【 Para.5 】

The various incidents differ in the details. OpenAI’s system was supposed to be kept offline. Its hacking spree started when it used a **hitherto** unknown **vulnerability** to break out of its virtual “sandbox” and on to the public internet. Anthropic’s system was supposed to be similarly limited, but human error meant it was not. The AISI always allows internet access as part of its tests. But it had never before seen models that were willing to accept **collateral** damage in order to breach their targets. Meta gave few details, but promised more when it had them.

这些事件在具体细节上各不相同。OpenAI的系统原本应该处于离线状态，但它利用一个此前未知的漏洞突

collateral a./n. /kə'lətərəl/ Additional but less important; unintended damage or suffering caused by an action or event. 附带的；间接的；附带损失；抵押品【考研英语词汇】

The war caused serious **collateral** damage to local communities. 这场战争给当地社区造成了严重的附带损害。

episode n. /'epɪsəʊd/ An event or situation that is part of a longer series of events; one part of a television or radio series. 一段经历；事件；（电视或广播的）一集【考研英语词汇】

The incident was just one **episode** in a long history of political conflict. 这起事件只是长期政治冲突中的一个插曲。

malicious a. /mə'liʃəs/ Intended to harm, upset, or damage someone or something. 恶意的；蓄意伤害的【考研英语词汇】

The company was the target of a **malicious** cyberattack.

这家公司成为一次恶意网络攻击的目标。

flurry n. /'flʌri/ A sudden short period of intense activity, excitement, or movement. 一阵忙乱；一阵活动；突然的激增【考研英语词汇】

The announcement caused a **flurry** of activity among investors. 这项声明引发了投资者的一阵忙碌。

autonomous a. /ɔ:'tɒnəməs/ Independent and able to make decisions or operate without being controlled by others. 自主的；自治的；自动的【考研英语词汇】

Autonomous vehicles could transform the future of transportation. 自动驾驶汽车可能改变未来的交通方式。

involvement n. /ɪn'vɒlvmənt/ The act of taking part in an activity or being connected with a situation or event. 参与；介入

sketch v./v. /sketʃ/ A simple drawing showing the main features of something; to describe or outline something briefly. 勾画【考研英语词汇】

The report **sketches** out a possible solution to the problem. 这份报告概述了一种可能的解决方案。

scheme n. /ski:m/ A plan or system for achieving a particular purpose; to make a secret or dishonest plan. 计划；方案【考研英语词汇】

float v. /fləʊt/ to put out some ideas 提出（想法等）【熟词僻义】

explicit a. /ɪk'splɪt/ Clearly stated, expressed, or shown, leaving no doubt about the meaning. 明确的；清楚的；直白的【考研英语词汇】

The report gives **explicit** instructions on how the system should be used. 这份报告明确说明了该系统应如何使用。

assessment n. /ə'sesmənt/ The process of judging or evaluating something, especially its quality, importance, or value. 评估；评价；评定【考研英语词汇】

The government conducted an **assessment** of the potential risks. 政府对潜在风险进行了评估。

wrongdoer n. /'rɒŋ du:ə/ A person who does something wrong or illegal. 做错事的人；违法者；作恶者

破了虚拟“沙盒”的限制，进入公共互联网，随后开始大肆发动网络攻击。Anthropic的系统原本也受到类似限制，但由于人为失误，这一限制并未得到落实。AISI在测试过程中一向允许模型接入互联网。但此前，它从未见过有模型为了攻破目标而不惜造成附带损害。Meta没有透露太多细节，但表示掌握更多信息后会公布。

【 Para.6 】

But the **episodes** show a new class of AI risk. Previous worries around cybersecurity, such as those voiced by Anthropic when it released its powerful Mythos model in April, have focused on the harm that **malicious** humans could do with AI tools in hand. Such fears have motivated proposals for new regulations. The **flurry** of **autonomous** hacks, where human **involvement** is limited to merely prompting the AIs, suggests those proposals are insufficient.

但这些事件表明，人工智能风险正在出现一种新的类型。此前，人们对网络安全的担忧——例如Anthropic在4月发布功能强大的Mythos模型时所表达的担忧——主要集中于恶意人士利用人工智能工具可能造成的危害。这类担忧促使人们提出制定新法规的方案。然而，近期一连串自主发起的网络攻击中，人类的参与仅限于向人工智能发出指令，这表明现有的监管方案还远远不够。

【 Para.7 】

Take the system of self-regulation **sketched** out by Demis Hassabis on July 14th. Google DeepMind's CEO (who said

contradiction n. /ˈkɒntrəˈdɪkʃn/ A situation in which two statements, ideas, or facts are opposite or cannot both be true. 矛盾；相互矛盾；不一致【考研英语大纲词汇】

There is a clear **contradiction** between his words and his actions. 他的言论和行为之间存在明显的矛盾。

fault n. /fɔːlt/ A mistake, defect, or responsibility for something that has gone wrong. 错误；缺点；过错；责任【考研英语大纲词汇】

It was not your **fault** that the project failed. 项目失败并不是你的错。

clarity /ˈklærəti/ The quality of being clear, easy to understand, or free from confusion. 清晰；清楚；明确【考研英语大纲词汇】

The report needs greater **clarity** to help readers understand the main argument. 这份报告需要更加清晰，以帮助读者理解核心论点。

employee n. /ɪmˈplɔɪ/ A person who is paid to work for an organization or another person. 雇员；员工【考研英语大纲词汇】

The company provides its **employees** with opportunities for further training. 公司为员工提供进一步培训的机会。

signatory n. /ˈsɪgnətəri/ A person, organization, or country that has signed an official agreement or document. 签署者；签署国；签约方

➤ 今日句子分析

On July 21st OpenAI, an American lab, said an unreleased

时间状语 主语 同谓语 谓语 宾语从句主语

model had escaped from a closed environment testing its

宾语从句谓语 宾语从句宾语

hacking skills, launching series attacks on HuggingFace, a

现在分词短语作伴随状语 谓语 宾语

Franco-American AI-infrastructure firm.

同谓语

句子成分分析：

主干

OpenAI, an American lab, said + 宾语从句

OpenAI: 主语

said: 谓语

an American lab: 同位语，补充说明 OpenAI

后面整个 an unreleased model... 是 said 的宾语从句

2. 宾语从句内部

an unreleased model had escaped from a closed environment testing its hacking skills

主干：

an unreleased model + had escaped + from...

an unreleased model: 主语

had escaped: 过去完成时，谓语

on August 5th that he was stepping down to become DeepMind's chair and chief scientist at Alphabet, Google's parent company) proposed a **scheme** that would see labs administer their own tests and withhold the public release of models that could not be verified as safe. Sam Altman, the boss of OpenAI, and Dario Amodei, who leads Anthropic, have **float**ed similar schemes.

以Demis Hassabis于7月14日提出的自我监管体系为例。谷歌DeepMind首席执行官Hassabis于8月5日表示，他将卸任CEO一职，转任DeepMind董事长兼首席科学家，并担任其母公司Alphabet的首席科学家。他提出了一项方案：由各家AI实验室自行开展测试，对于无法证明其安全性的模型，则不向公众发布。

OpenAI负责人Sam Altman和Anthropic负责人Dario Amodei也提出过类似的方案。

【 Para.8 】

The ideas are good: labs ought to be **explicit** about the safety standards which apply in their **assessments**, and enforce them on the third parties that do the work. But autonomous hacking proves that AI models can be dangerous even if the public cannot get hold of them. All three of the hacks took place during precisely the sorts of tests that Sir Demis has suggested.

这些想法本身是好的：各家AI实验室应当明确说明其评估所采用的安全标准，并要求负责开展测试的第三方严格执行这些标准。但自主网络攻击表明，即使公众无法接触到AI模型，它们依然可能带来危险。三起攻击事件恰恰都发生在Demis所建议的这类测试过程

from a closed environment: 介词短语，表示“从一个封闭环境中逃出”

testing its hacking skills: 现在分词短语，作伴随状语

其中：testing its hacking skills逻辑主语是 an unreleased model: 该模型在测试自己的黑客攻击能力时逃出了封闭环境。

3. launching series attacks...

launching series attacks on HuggingFace这是现在分词短语作伴随状语，表示随后发生的动作。

逻辑主语仍然是 an unreleased model:

逃出封闭环境 → 随后发动一系列攻击

所以可以理解为：and launched a series of attacks on HuggingFace。这里原文的 launching 使句子更加紧凑。

4. 两个同位语

OpenAI, an American lab

= OpenAI, 一家美国实验室

HuggingFace, a Franco-American AI-infrastructure firm

= HuggingFace, 一家法美AI基础设施公司

➤ 写作积累

(Para.5)The various incidents differ in the details.

differ in: 在.....方面不同；在.....上存在差异。1. 基本用法

A and B differ in + 名词。表示两者在某个具体方面存在差异。

The two products differ in price and quality.这两种产品在价格和质量上存在差异。该词汇有以下近义表达：

vary in: 在.....方面有所不同；存在差异。和 differ in 非常接近，但 vary in 更强调程度、范围、数量等存在变化，常用于 size, price, degree, quality, extent 等。The symptoms vary in severity from person to person. 症状的严重程度因人而异。

be distinct from ... in ...: 在.....方面与.....有明显区别。distinct from 比 different from 语气更强，强调两者之间存在清晰、明显的区别。

vary between ... and ...: 在.....之间变化；因.....而异。当差异表现为一个范围或区间时，常用这个结构，而不是 differ in。Temperatures vary between 10 and 20 degrees in winter. 冬季气温在10到20度之间变化。

(Para.5)Anthropic's system was supposed to be similarly limited, but human error meant it was not.

be supposed to be + 名词/形容词/介词短语，核心意思是：本应是.....；按理说是.....；应该处于.....状态。该词汇有以下近义词汇：

be expected to be: 计是.....；预期是.....强调人们根据已有信息、计划或情况，预计某事会是某种状态。比 be supposed to be 更强调“预期”。The new system is expected to be more efficient than the old one. 预计新系统会比旧系统更加高效。

be intended to be: 旨在成为.....；计划是.....；设计为.....和 be meant to be 类似，但更加正式，常见于正式文件、政策、技术说

中。

【 Para.9 】

The hacks also present a challenge for legal systems. Hacking, when humans do it, is a crime. When an AI is the **wrongdoer**, though, it is unclear how to assign blame. The law in America relies on intentionality, notes Rune Kvist, head of Artificial Intelligence Underwriting Company, which insures AI firms. If no human intended to hack anyone, no crime can have happened. The ability to sue for damages is limited too. And yet harm has clearly occurred. That **contradiction**, says Mr Kvist, is “unacceptable”. Gabe Weil of the Institute for Law and AI, in Massachusetts, proposes a system of strict liability. As with rules around keeping wild animals, it would assume that any harm is always the **fault** of the party carrying out the risky activity. 这些网络攻击也给现有法律体系带来了挑战。人类实施黑客攻击属于犯罪，但如果AI才是违法行为的实施者，那么该由谁承担责任就很难说清楚。人工智能保险公司负责人Rune Kvist指出，美国法律以主观故意为依据。如果没有任何人有意攻击他人，那么从法律上说，犯罪行为可能就没有发生。受害者提起损害赔偿诉讼的空间也同样有限。然而，造成的

明等。The new policy is intended to be a long-term solution to the problem. 这项新政策旨在成为解决这一问题的长期方案。

损害显然已经发生。Kvist认为，这种矛盾是“不可接受的”。马萨诸塞州人工智能与法律研究所的Gabe Weil提出，可以建立严格责任制度。正如有关饲养野生动物的法律规定一样，该制度将认定：任何损害都应由实施这项高风险活动的一方承担责任。

【 Para.10 】

The industry wants **clarity**, too. An open letter from **employees** at several large AI labs, whose **signatories** include Dr Amodei, asks for help from America’s government in “pacing” AI progress. But help is coming at the speed of government, not technology: a meeting this week to establish how the White House could assess models ended with no public commitments, and few reports of progress.

AI行业同样希望有明确的规则。几家大型AI实验室的员工联名发表了一封公开信，签署者包括Amodei博士，他们在信中请求美国政府帮助“控制”AI发展的速度。然而，政府提供帮助遵循的是政府的办事，而非技术发展的速度：本周举行的一场旨在确定白宫如何评估AI模型的会议最终没有作出任何公开承诺，也鲜有进展的消息传出。